

Hackles Mentors • Service Hours, Badges and Certificates

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · October 2026

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FIELD NOTE	No. 1
Status: DRAFT. Whether service hours count toward graduation, scholarships, honor societies or the co-curricular transcript is a college decision. [LOCAL] Recognition never includes names or photos of children. Digital badges contain the mentor's name only, with the mentor's consent.	

01 What counts as a service hour

ACTIVITY	HOURS CREDITED
Four-hour training (once, plus refreshers)	Training hours as logged [4]
Event shift at a school or library (including set-up and clean-up)	Actual time on site
Pre-event briefing with the Station Lead	Actual time
Station preparation (printing, cutting cards, art for the Passport)	Up to [2] hours per event, with Station Lead approval
Recruiting table or club presentation	Actual time, up to [4] per semester
Written reflection at the end of the semester	[1]
Debrief after an event	Actual time

TRAVEL TIME TO AND from events does not count unless the college decides otherwise [LOCAL]. Keep a simple log with the date, event, hours, and Station Lead initials. No child names or details.

02 Levels and badges

LEVEL	REQUIREMENTS (ADAPT LOCALLY)	DIGITAL BADGE NAME
Hackles Mentor	Training complete; screening complete; at least [10] service hours and [2] events; clean conduct record	Hackles Mentor
Hackles Station Lead	Mentor for at least [2] events; Station Lead supplement; observed by the coordinator; at least [25] service hours	Hackles Station Lead
Hackles Program Fellow	Station Lead for a semester; helped train mentors, or ran a recruiting or planning task; at least [50] service hours; faculty advisor recommendation	Hackles Program Fellow
Hackles Mentor of the Term (optional recognition)	Nominated by a Station Lead or teacher	Hackles Mentor of the Term

BADGES ARE NEVER RANKED against each other publicly, and nobody is required to reach any level.

03 Digital badge text (Open Badges style)

COLLEGES OFTEN ISSUE BADGES through a credential platform [LOCAL]. Use this text. Include no data about children.

Hackles Mentor

- **Name:** Hackles Mentor
- **Issuer:** [COLLEGE NAME] [DEPARTMENT OR OFFICE]
- **Description:** Earned by a student who completed screening and four hours of training in child-safety boundaries, the Hackles routine (Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.), and disclosure handoff, and who served at least [10] hours supporting teachers at K-12 digital-safety events.
- **Criteria:** (1) Passed the college's screening for contact with minors. (2) Completed the four-hour training and signed the code of conduct. (3) Served at least [10] hours across at least [2] events. (4) Completed a reflection. (5) Received a positive review from a Station Lead.
- **Skills:** Facilitation, child-safe communication, boundary-setting, supporting a teacher-led lesson, teamwork, digital-safety literacy.
- **Evidence:** A verified service log, held by the coordinator. No evidence includes any child's information.
- **Alignment (optional):** [LOCAL service-learning or co-curricular competencies]
- **Expires:** [Never / After 2 years unless renewed]

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Hackles Station Lead

- **Description:** Earned by a Hackles Mentor who led a station or team at school events, briefed other mentors, kept their station in sight of school staff, and handled first questions from mentors under the supervision of the coordinator.
- **Criteria:** Hackles Mentor badge; Station Lead supplement; led at least [2] events; observed by the coordinator; [25] service hours.
- **Skills:** Team leadership, briefing, supervision, safeguarding practice.

Hackles Program Fellow

- **Description:** Earned by a Station Lead who supported the program for a semester by helping to train new mentors or by taking on a planning, recruiting or materials role.
- **Criteria:** Station Lead badge; at least [50] service hours; faculty advisor recommendation.
- **Skills:** Program leadership, training, project management.

04 Certificate text

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
Certificate of Service [COLLEGE NAME] · [DEPARTMENT OR OFFICE] This certificate recognizes [MENTOR NAME] for [HOURS] hours of service as a Hackles [LEVEL] during [SEMESTER, YEAR], helping teachers at local schools and libraries teach children the habit of Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. [Signature: Faculty Advisor] · [Signature: Coordinator] · [Signature: Dean or Director] Date: [DATE] <i>The Hackles name and mark are used with permission under the Hackles license notice. [VERIFY with counsel]</i>	

05 Transcript and recognition lines

- **Co-curricular transcript line:** "Hackles Mentors, volunteer service-learning program: [HOURS] hours, [SEMESTER]." [LOCAL]
- **Resume line (offered to mentors):** "Hackles Mentor, [COLLEGE NAME]: trained in child-safe boundaries and disclosure handoff; supported teacher-led digital-safety lessons for [number] classes across [number] events." Mentors may use their own numbers. No schools or children named.
- **Recommendation letters:** The advisor writes letters only on request and only about what they saw directly.
- **Honor society or award:** [LOCAL]

06 End-of-semester reflection (one page, graded pass or no pass if used for a course)

PROMPTS FOR THE MENTOR (no child names or identifying details):

1. What did you do at events, and what did you learn about teaching and about yourself?
2. Describe a moment when you used a boundary or a hand-off. What did you notice?
3. What did you learn about digital safety that you did not know?
4. How did the role connect to your major or career interests?
5. What would you change to make the program better?

The advisor reads reflections for learning. Reflections are not shared outside the program without the mentor's permission.

07 Record keeping

KEEP SERVICE LOGS AND badge records in the coordinator's secure file. The impact tracker never contains names, hours by person, badge lists or any child data.

Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled study.